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INDUSTRY TALK REPORT:

BRIDGING DATA & DECISIONS

**THE ROLE OF DATA GOVERNANCE AND DATA MANAGEMENT IN MODERN BUSINESS
INTELLIGENCE**

LECTURER: DR. NOORFA HASZLINNA BINTI MUSTAFFA

STUDENT NAME	MATRIC NO
GUI KAH SIN	A23CS0080
SABRINA HENG WEI QI	A23CS0265
WOO CHENG SHUAN	A23CS0283

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1.0 Introduction

Faiz Fablillah, a Senior Chief Enterprise Data and AI Governance Expert at PIDM, delivered a two hours industry presentation titled “Bridging Data and Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence (BI)”. With over 15 years of cross-industry experience, he shared his profound insights into the importance of data governance and data management in supporting modern business intelligence and analytics practices.

In his presentation, we explored numerous topics related to data management, such as the importance of data governance, why data governance is so important, what data governance and data management are and how various industries are transforming in cooperation with the development of artificial intelligence. The speaker also discussed the potential impact of these changes on the future development of data-related careers.

When discussing BI and analytics, the speaker pointed out that data governance is the bridge connecting raw data with trusted data. It precedes any analysis or decision-making process. The speaker believes that a good governance ecosystem can integrate all these elements to provide trust, consistency and reliability within an organization’s data environment.

2.0 Key Takeaways

2.1 The role and responsibilities of an Analytics Engineer

A key takeaway from the presentation was that analytics engineers act as a bridge between raw data aggregation and business decisions. They are responsible for cleaning, processing and transforming messy or fragmented data into clear, reliable and meaningful information for dashboards, reports, analytics and more. The presenter pointed out that data governance is crucial for ensuring data credibility. Business intelligence (BI) is more than just technical expertise. This is because no matter how powerful your data analytics and visualization products are, you need business insight to make informed decisions in today’s BI environment.

2.2 How analytics bridges the gap between raw data and business decisions

In today’s business world, business intelligence cannot work well on its own because the value of any dashboard depends entirely on the quality of the data feeding into it. Companies can gather a ton of information from hundreds of sources, but they rarely get the information to the point of making good decisions. That is where analytics engineering steps in to bridge the gap. In reality, data pipelines are often a mess, filled with duplicate records, undocumented systems, confusing labels and conflicting numbers. Without analytics to step in and organize this chaos, frontend dashboards end up displaying incorrect information, which leads managers to make the wrong business choices.

The speaker explained that data governance is the actual bridge between raw data and trustworthy decisions. If this protective bridge is missing, data tools can lead to what the speaker mentioned, when a company has beautiful, colourful charts that look great but are based on the wrong data. It is a very serious issue for the industries of the present day. Research indicates that about 73% of company data is gathered but never utilized, and only about 3% of corporate data has basic quality. Analytics cleans up poor data and resolves integration problems to give a clean, trustworthy resource from a chaotic stack of raw inputs. This way, final dashboards will display the actual business situation and not errors in the system.

2.3 Tools, technologies, or practices mentioned

Building a reliable data setup requires a smart mix of modern software and clear, day-to-day work habits. The presentation highlighted this balance by introducing the Data Management Body of Knowledge (DAMA-DMBOK2) framework. This is a widely used industry guide that organizes eleven different areas of data management such as data quality, architecture, master data, metadata and security. By following these organized practices, companies can stop fixing data errors on the fly and instead build a consistent, step-by-step process for handling their data from start to finish.

A key practice the speaker emphasized is the strict separation between data governance and data management. Data governance is all about setting the rules, defining the company's goals and deciding who has the authority to make choices about the data. On the other hand, data management is the hands-on engineering work required to actually build systems and follow those rules. The speaker shared an easy-to-understand analogy: data governance represents the traffic laws, while data management is the actual act of driving the car. Ultimately, to successfully take raw data and turn it into a working dashboard, the system must smoothly gather the data, fix database connection issues, keep sensitive information secure and follow strict legal regulations.

2.4 Real-world use cases or examples shared by the speaker

To ground the discussion in reality, Mr Faiz Fablillah has discussed about challenges faced by three industry cases without data governance and the solution with its result. The first involved a Malaysian Bank where customer records were scattered across multiple systems inconsistently. The bank was able to consolidate everything into a single, reliable customer view after implementing Master Data Management with automated data quality monitoring and ultimately speeding up BI delivery. The second case came from telecommunications company drowning in over 200 dashboards that nobody trusted. Through data lineage tracking, quality scorecards and the data catalog, it increased the adoption triple and reduced dashboard count to reliable 50. Lastly, the healthcare provider facing sensitive patient data across 15 systems under strict PDPA compliance. The systems deployed automated personally identifiable information (PII) detection, intelligent access controls and immutable audit trails to achieve zero data breaches while accelerating research data provisioning. Overall, these cases have emphasized the importance of having data governance as it is a practical necessity that drives measurable business outcomes.

3.0 Reflection and Critical Insights

Gui Kah Sin

The talk centred on data governance and why it plays such a crucial role in turning raw data into decisions that can be trusted. Good governance is not merely a technical concern but rather a framework of clear policies, shared responsibilities and standards that ensure data remains quality, compliant and accountable throughout an organization. This is what makes it so fundamental to business intelligence, as no dashboard or report is more reliable than the data behind it. The real-world cases shared during the talk made this extremely tangible, showing that when governance is neglected, organizations face costly reconciliation efforts, regulatory consequences and a gradual erosion of trust in their own data. Looking ahead, governance itself is also evolving, with manual processes steadily giving way to AI-assisted and automated frameworks that promise more consistent and accurate data to support better decision-making in the future.

Sabrina Heng Wei Qi

The 2 hours presentation by Mr. Faiz Fablillah was a necessary reality check that managed to connect academic data training with industry standards. In data engineering labs, the focus is on learning how to prepare, clean, transform and create ETL pipelines. These labs are great for understanding how to work with datasets but can also separate data pipelines from the institutional context. The presentation solutions on the frontend structurally incomplete without the underlying integrity, quality and strict compliance of the moving data assets. That 73% of enterprise data is completely unused and only 3% is of basic quality is significant systemic weakness in today's corporate architectures. This is a testament that the real challenge structured governance to put that information to use and to ensure its trustworthiness. If there are no guidelines on the use of metadata and data lineages, pipelines can lead to a serious problem, creating beautiful dashboards that hide poor and questionable data inputs. With industries moving towards AI, it is now technically necessary to separate data governance and data management, and having good balance between programming the pipelines and being data literate in the organization is what true engineering excellence is about.

Woo Cheng Shuan

The two-hour talk gave a better understanding of data management, data governance and artificial intelligence. The discussion clearly demonstrated from managing data sources to its implementation of the necessity of data governance in real-world situations. Governance is crucial since trust, accountability, compliance, and AI security cannot be guaranteed by focusing only on business intelligence. The speaker also explained that although automation and AI are constantly developing and becoming highly capable, human "caution" is still essential when it comes to data protection and responsibility. This highlights how crucial it is to strike a balance between BI expertise, data governance and systems thinking rather than depending on automation in today's data-driven sector.

4.0 Conclusion

In conclusion, the industry talk by Mr. Faiz Fablillah has offered valuable insights of how importance data governance and management are in today's business landscape. His extensive cross-industry experience lent credibility to every point raised, from the systemic challenges of poor data quality to the strategic necessity of separating governance from management. The most impactful realization was that technical proficiency in building pipelines and dashboards is only half the equation because without proper governance, even the most sophisticated analytics tools or techniques can mislead rather than inform. This talk has broadened the understanding of what it truly means to data-centric roles, highlighting the future careers in business intelligence will demand not only coding and pipeline ability but also genuine appreciation for data stewardship, compliance and organizational trust. It also emphasized about the growing intersection between AI deployment and responsible data governance will become a need in the future. It encouraged to think further about how data powering AI systems is held to the same rigorous standards expected of human-driven data governance. The three real-world cases shared during the talk made it evident that the consequences of neglecting data quality will bring a big loss to the business. Ultimately, the talk also shared about data governance is not a one-time implementation but ongoing commitment that organizations must embed into their processes in order to remain competitive, compliance and trustworthy in an increasingly data-driven world.